

NASREEN BEGUM

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Profile Summary

Nasreen Begum is a distinguished legislative expert and former judicial officer, currently serving as an Advocate of the Supreme Court of Bangladesh. She is actively engaged as a consultant in several high-profile government and development partner-supported initiatives, contributing her extensive legal and regulatory expertise to national development efforts. Notably, she is providing consultancy support to the World Health Organization (WHO) for drafting the Drug Control Rules 2026 (English and Bengali) under the Drugs and Cosmetics Act 2023, with a focus on strengthening the legal and regulatory framework for vaccines and medicines in Bangladesh in line with WHO guidelines and international good regulatory practices. She also served as Consultant for the United States Pharmacopeia (USP) on the project titled “Translation of the Drugs & Cosmetics Act 2023 and Drafting of Cosmetics Rules 2024, Imposition and Recovery of Administrative Penalty Rules 2024”, where she has played a key role in translating the Act into English and drafting critical subsidiary legislation to support regulatory reform in the pharmaceuticals and cosmetics sector. Additionally, she is consulting for the Infrastructure Investment Facilitation Company (IIFC) on a landmark initiative focused on the codification and systematic organization of secondary legislation in Bangladesh, aimed at enhancing legal clarity and accessibility.

She serves as a panel lawyer for the Supreme Court Legal Aid Committee and was the founding Director of the National Legal Aid Services Organization, reflecting her deep commitment to justice and public legal service. In November 2024, she was appointed Chairman of the Arbitration Tribunal of the Federation of Bangladesh Chambers of Commerce and Industry (FBCCI), where she leads arbitration efforts to promote alternative dispute resolution in commercial matters. From November 2025, she has also been serving as Chairman of the Investment Protection Fund (IPF) under the Dhaka Stock Exchange.

She previously served as Member (Law) of Bangladesh Competition Commission for three years. She retired as the Additional Secretary of Ministry of Law, Justice & Parliamentary Affairs. With over 20 years of experience in legislative drafting and legal reform, Nasreen Begum is widely recognized as a legislative expert. She joined the Bangladesh Judicial Service as an Assistant Judge (formerly Munsiff) on 20 April 1983, and served in various judicial capacities for over a decade. She was also the first General Secretary of the Bangladesh Women Judges Association.

Her academic contributions include teaching at ICSB, ICAB, and ICMAB. She has served as an Independent Director of the Dhaka Stock Exchange, Project Director for initiatives supported by UNICEF and CIDA, and National Focal Point for UNCAC. She has participated in numerous international trainings across the USA, UK, Canada, Japan, and other countries, focusing on justice reform, legislative processes, arbitration, competition law, and rights-based legal frameworks.

DATE OF BIRTH	31 August 1959
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NATIONALITY	Bangladeshi
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EMPLOYMENT RECORD

Employer-1
Bangladesh Competition
Commission

Designation: Member (Law)
From March 2020 to February 2023

Main responsibilities:

- Performing judicial activities under the provision of the Competition Act, 2012.
- Adjudicating cases on competition related issues.
- Determining financial penalties or other appropriate remedies in competition cases.
- Drafting Rules and Regulations under the Competition Act 2012.

Employer-2
Legislative &
Parliamentary Affairs
Division, Ministry of Law,
Justice & Parliamentary
Affairs.

Designation: Additional Secretary (Drafting)

From February 2012 to August 2018

Main responsibilities:

- Drafting and finalizing the draft of principal legislations, subordinate legislations, statutory orders, notifications, rules & regulations
- Vetting national and international agreements, treaties and other legal instruments.
- Performing supervisory role of Translation Section and finalizing legal translation of Laws, Rules and Regulations both in English to Bengali and Bengali to English.
- Providing legislative opinion as and when required by the concerned Government offices.
- Representing parliamentary standing committee meetings
- Performing the role of Secretary-in-charge as and when required

Designation: Joint Secretary (Drafting)

From March 2005 to February 2012

Main responsibilities:

- Drafting of principal legislations, subordinate legislations, statutory orders, notifications, rules & regulations
- Vetting national and international agreements, treaties and other legal instruments.
- Performing supervisory role as a team leader of different ministerial activities done by up to Deputy Secretary and finalizing the draft bills to put up before Additional secretary for final scrutiny.
- Translation of Laws, Rules and Regulations both in English to Bengali and Bengali to English.
- National focal point of UNCAC (United Nations Convention against Corruption).
- Project Director of different projects of UNICEF & CIDA.

Designation: Deputy Secretary (Drafting)

From May 1998 to March 2005

Main responsibilities:

- Primary draft of principal legislations, subordinate legislations, statutory orders, notifications, rules & regulations.
- Vetting national and international agreements, treaties and other legal instruments.
- Director of National Legal Aid Services Association.
- Preparation of legal aid rules, regulation and guidelines under the Legal Aid Act

Designation: Senior Assistant Secretary (Drafting)

From July 1996 to April 1998

Main responsibilities:

- Primary draft of principal legislations, subordinate legislations, statutory orders, notifications, rules & regulations.
- Provide legislative opinion as and when required by the concerned Government offices.
- Perform duties delegated by senior officers.

	Designation: Assistant Secretary (Drafting) From April 1990 to June 1994 Main responsibilities: • Primary draft of principal legislations, subordinate legislations, statutory orders, notifications, rules & regulations • Perform duties delegated by senior officers. Employer-3 Bangladesh Judicial Service Designation: Joint District Judge From July 1994 to June 1996 Main responsibilities: • Adjudicating legal proceedings of criminal and civil nature. • Conducting hearing and taking evidence of both civil and criminal trials. • Pronouncing judgments and orders. • Enforcing court orders Designation: Assistant Judge and Senior Assistant Judge From April 1983 to March 1990 Main responsibilities: • Adjudicating disputes between parties involving rent control, family matters, property law, election matters, etc. • Pronouncing judgments and orders. • Administration of the concerned court.								
MEMBERSHIP IN PROFESSIONAL SOCIETIES	• Advocate, Supreme Court of Bangladesh • Chairman, Arbitration Tribunal of the Federation of Bangladesh Chambers of Commerce and Industry (FBCCI) • Chairman, Investment Protection Fund (IPF), Dhaka Stock Exchange. • Member, Bangladesh Supreme Court Bar Association • Member, Bangladesh Legislative Service Association • Member, Bangladesh Law Association • Member and Founding General Secretary, Bangladesh Women Judges Association • General Secretary, Retired Judges Forum Association • Member, Officers Club Dhaka • Advisor, Foundation of Chartered Taxation of Bangladesh (FCTB)								
EDUCATIONAL BACKGROUND	<table> <tr> <td>Master of Laws (LL.M) University of Dhaka</td> <td>1982</td> </tr> <tr> <td>Bachelor of Laws (LL.B) University of Dhaka</td> <td>1981</td> </tr> <tr> <td>Higher Secondary Certificate (HSC) Bodrunnesa Mohila College, Dhaka</td> <td>1977</td> </tr> <tr> <td>Secondary School Certificate (SSC) Azimpur Girl's High School, Dhaka</td> <td>1975</td> </tr> </table>	Master of Laws (LL.M) University of Dhaka	1982	Bachelor of Laws (LL.B) University of Dhaka	1981	Higher Secondary Certificate (HSC) Bodrunnesa Mohila College, Dhaka	1977	Secondary School Certificate (SSC) Azimpur Girl's High School, Dhaka	1975
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TRAININGS

July, 2015	Indonesia Study Tour on 'Juvenile Justice and Care of Children'
December, 2012	Brussels Joined as a Member of EU-Joint Commission Meeting on Good Governance & Human Rights issue
November, 2007	European Joint Commission European Joint Commission Sub-Group meeting held in Dhaka, Bangladesh.
October, 2007	Asia Colloquium Asia Colloquium gender related issue in Dhaka
May, 2006	Academy for Planning & Development (APD) Orientation Course on Gender and Development jointly organized by Academy for Planning and Development (APD) and Ministry of Women & Children Affairs in Dhaka.
January, 2006	WIPO Sub-Regional Forum WIPO Sub-Regional Forum on IP Cooperation among Member States of SAARC.
2002-2005	Human Rights Summer School Program Participated 2nd to 12th Human Rights Summer School Program Organized by ELCOP.
September, 2005	Exercise Based Legislative Drafting Training program on "Exercise based Legislative Drafting" jointly organized by Department of Justice of the Government of Canada and Ministry of Law, Justice and Parliamentary Affairs, held in Bangladesh.
November, 2003	'Delegated Legislation' Seminar Training on "Delegated legislation" jointly organized by Department of Justice of the Government of Canada and Ministry of Law, Justice and Parliamentary Affairs, held in Dhaka, Bangladesh.
September, 2003	Non-lethal Weapons Seminar Non-lethal Weapons Seminar held at the Bangladesh Institute of Peace Support Operation Training BIPSOT at Razendrapur, Gazipur.
April, 2003	'Statutory Interpretation' Training Training on 'Statutory Interpretation' jointly organized by Department of Justice of the Government of Canada and Ministry of Law, Justice and Parliamentary Affairs, held in Dhaka, Bangladesh.
November, 2002	'Basic Principle of Legislative Drafting' Training Training Program on 'Basic Principles of Legislative Drafting' jointly organized by Ministry of Law, Justice & Parliamentary Affairs and Department of Justice of the Government of Canada, held in Dhaka, Bangladesh.
August-September, 2002	Computer Training Computer Tainting conducted by Bangladesh Computer Council and sponsored by Canadian International Development Agency CIDA), held in Dhaka, Bangladesh.

FOREIGN SEMINARS & CONFERENCES

June, 2012	Viena UNCAC Review Mechanisms Regional Conference
February, 2012	United Kingdom Study tour for the Companies Act Reform Committee to visit the UK Companies House and the UK Ministry of Commerce Business Innovation and Skills (BIS) Department
October, 2011	Morocco Attended 4th State Party Conference to the United Nations Convention Against Corruption (UNCAC) held in Marrakesh.
June, 2011	Fiji To review Fiji's UNCAC implementation, along with USA.
April, 2011	Australia & Singapore Study Tour for gathering practical experience of Whistle Blowing Protection System & Office of the Ombudsman in Australia & Singapore.
March, 2011	Singapore Training on Global Financial Governance in Singapore.
November, 2009	Qatar Attending 3rd State Party Conference to the UN Convention Against Corruption (UNCAC) held in Doha, Qatar.
May, 2009	Kuwait Sharing experience as a resource person in Kuwait regarding UNCAC Implementation Assessment under Governance and Integrity Program of the World Bank.
August, 2008	South Korea Developing the Training Capacity of the Bangladesh Civil Service Administration Academy held in Korean Development International Agency (KOICA)
January, 2008	Indonesia Attended 2nd State Party Conference to the United Nations Convention Against Corruption (UNCAC) held in Bali, Indonesia
December, 2007	Philippines Regional Conference on Legal Empowerment held in Manila
November, 2007	Netherlands 9th Annual Meeting of National Authorities for Chemical Weapons Convention
November-December, 2006	Canada Training on Legislative Drafting & Gender Equality Organized by Department of Justice of Canada under the Bangladesh Legal Reform Project (Part-A) held in Ottawa.
November, 2005	Thailand Joined the ILO Regional Workshop on Legal Frameworks and Law Enforcement Capacity in Combating Child Trafficking for Labour and Sexual Exploitation held in Thailand.

November, 2005	Cambodia Study Visit on Child Protection system in Cambodia.
November, 2004	Macao & China Joined the 10th ACPE World Conference on "Crime Prevention and Criminal Justice" held in Macao, China.
October, 2004	Canada Study tour on Legal Aid in Toronto, Canada.
July, 2004	USA Joined in UN CEDAW Committee meeting at New York
November, 2003	Belgium Joined in EC-Bangladesh Joint Commission meeting at Brussels.
September, 2003	Thailand Study Tour in Thailand to visit good examples of national structure to address Child Sexual abuse and Child Sexual Exploitation.
June, 2003	Canada International Legal Aid Conference held in Canada.
October- November, 2002	Japan 5th training course on "Corruption Control in Criminal Justice" held in Tokyo.
2000 & 2001	USA Participated Workshop on Law relating to Power and Energy in U.S.A.
September, 1997	UK Participated in Seminar on "FINANCING INTERNATIONAL ENERGY PROJECTS" held in London, UK.
April, 1997	India Managing Human rights Institution Course held in India.
November, 1991- February, 1992	India International Training Program on Legislative Drafting held in Lok Sabha Secretariat, Parliament of India, New Delhi.
CONSULTANCIES AND KEY PROJECTS UNDERTAKEN	
Consultancy Title: Consultancy support in drafting the Rules under the Drugs and Cosmetics Act 2023, with a focus on strengthening the legal and regulatory framework for vaccines and medicines Main assignment/ Project: Drafting of Drug Control Rules 2026 (English and Bengali) Year: October 2025 – December 2025 Location: Bangladesh Client: World Health Organization (WHO)	

Main project features: This project focused on drafting comprehensive Drug Control Rules to operationalize the Drugs and Cosmetics Act 2023 in Bangladesh. The Rules cover the full regulatory framework governing drugs, vaccines, biologics, and cosmetics, including regulatory oversight, procedural requirements, licensing, manufacturing, import, export, distribution, quality control, and administrative enforcement. The drafts were prepared in alignment with the Directorate General of Drug Administration's (DGDA) operational requirements, WHO guidelines, international good regulatory practices, and applicable national legislation.

Position: Legal Consultant

Activities performed:

- Drafting the Drug Control Rules 2026 in both English and Bengali to ensure legal accuracy, consistency, and accessibility.
- Reviewing the Drugs and Cosmetics Act 2023 and relevant subsidiary legislation to ensure full operationalization through the proposed Rules.
- Aligning draft provisions with WHO technical guidelines, international regulatory standards, and good regulatory practices.
- Incorporating DGDA's regulatory procedures and administrative requirements into the drafting framework.
- Consulting with regulatory authorities and technical experts to validate practical applicability and compliance feasibility.
- Revising and finalizing the draft Rules based on stakeholder feedback for submission to the competent authorities.
- Preparing supporting legal notes and documentation to facilitate regulatory implementation.

Name of assignment or project: Translation of the Drugs & Cosmetics Act 2023 and Drafting of Cosmetics Rules 2024, Imposition and Recovery of Administrative Penalty Rules 2024 under the Drugs & Cosmetics Act 2023

Year: November 2023 – June 2025

Location: Dhaka, Bangladesh

Client: United States Pharmacopeia (USP) in collaboration with relevant government agencies

Main project features: This project aims to support the regulatory reform process in Bangladesh's pharmaceutical and cosmetics sectors by translating the Drugs & Cosmetics Act 2023 into English and developing a comprehensive set of draft Cosmetics Rules 2024 and Imposition and Recovery of Administrative Penalty Rules 2024 under the Drugs & Cosmetics Act 2023. The initiative is intended to enhance legal clarity, facilitate regulatory enforcement, and align domestic laws with international standards.

Position: Legal Consultant.

Activities performed:

- Translating the Drugs & Cosmetics Act 2023 from Bangla to English, ensuring legal accuracy and contextual consistency.
- Conducting a thorough review of existing related laws, rules, and international best practices.
- Drafting the Cosmetics Rules 2024 and Imposition and Recovery of Administrative Penalty Rules 2024 under the Drugs & Cosmetics Act 2023 in alignment with the objectives and framework of the 2023 Act.
- Collaborating with stakeholders, including legal experts and regulatory authorities, to incorporate feedback and ensure practical applicability.
- Revising and finalizing the draft rules for submission to the competent authorities.
- Preparing legal documentation, briefing notes, and translation outputs to support implementation and policy decision-making.

Name of assignment or project: Codification of Secondary Legislation of Bangladesh

Year: 2025 – Ongoing

Location: Dhaka, Bangladesh

Client: Infrastructure Investment Facilitation Company (IIFC) in collaboration with relevant ministries

Main project features: The objective of this project is to develop a comprehensive and accessible legal framework by identifying, compiling, and codifying existing secondary legislation (rules, regulations, orders, etc.) of Bangladesh. The project aims to enhance legal clarity, reduce redundancy, and support better regulatory governance by organizing secondary legislation under relevant primary laws.

Position: Consultant (Legal Expert)

Activities performed:

- Reviewing and analyzing existing secondary legislation across various sectors.
- Mapping and linking secondary legislation to corresponding primary laws.
- Identifying legal gaps, inconsistencies, and areas requiring harmonization.
- Recommending updates and necessary revisions to ensure coherence and legal clarity.
- Supporting the development of a codified and categorized database of secondary legislation.
- Collaborating with relevant ministries and legal institutions to validate findings and proposed structures.
- Preparing and presenting legal reports and policy briefs as part of the codification process.

Name of assignment or project: Policy Advocacy & Legislative Reform for Children

Year: 2013-2016

Location: Dhaka

Client: UNICEF and relevant ministries

Main project features: The main objective of this project was to review the existing laws relating to children in Bangladesh and recommend amendment as well as draft new legislation in this regard.

Position: Project Director

Activities performed:

- Reviewing existing laws and regulations of our country relating to children.
- Preparing gap analysis report and need assessment.
- Preparing a Draft Children Act to fulfill the objectives of the assignment
- Finalizing the draft of Children Act, 2013 which came into effect on 21 August 2013.
- Preparing Rules and Regulations under the Children Act, 2013.
- Translate the documents in English.

Name of assignment or project: Canadian International Development Agency (CIDA) Legal Reform Project

Year: 2003-2006

Location: Dhaka

Client: CIDA, relevant ministries and prison authority.

Main project features: The Project aimed at establishing a mechanism to provide free legal assistance from the government to the poor and marginalized people of Bangladesh.

Position: Focal Point

Activities performed:

- Facilitating meetings with the relevant ministries, prison authority, police, lawyers, victims, prisoners and other key national stakeholders with a view of establishing a mechanism for free legal assistance.
- Conducting district and national level seminars and workshops.
- Drafting and finalizing Legal Aid Act, 2000.
- Drafting Rules and Regulations under the Act
- Establishing National Legal Aid Services Organization (NLASO) under the Act.
- Consultancy meeting for amending Jail Code and reforming Prison Act.

Name of assignment or project: UNCAC- A Bangladesh Compliance and Gap Analysis

Year: 2007-2009

Location: Dhaka

Client: United Nations office on Drugs and Crime (UNODC), United Nations Development Program (UNDP)

Main project features: The main objective of this project was analysis of compatibility and compliance of national laws and practice with the provisions in certain selected key thematic areas of the UNCAC, indicate key challenges for the government of Bangladesh in implementation of the convention and to build internal support for the implementation of the UNCAC among key decision-makers.

Position: Focal point in core research team

Activities performed:

- Extensive research on corruption related existing laws in Bangladesh.
- Compatibility between UNCAC and domestic legal/regulatory regime
- Compliance and gap between law and practice
- Amendment of Anti-Corruption Commission Act, 2004 and Anti-Corruption Commission Rules, 2007
- Amendment of Money Laundering Prevention Act, 2002.
- Recommendation of enactment of Whistleblower Protection Act and amendment of Extradition Act

Name of assignment or project: Women in Development (WID)

Year: 2002-2008

Location: Dhaka

Client: Ministry of Women and Children Affairs

Main project features: The objective of this assignment was to ensure women development in Bangladesh through reviewing the existing women related laws and recommending necessary amendments.

Position: Focal Points

Activities performed:

- Reviewing the existing women related laws of Bangladesh
- Compatibility between Convention on the Elimination of All Forms of Discrimination Against Women (CEDAW) and domestic laws
- Recommendation for amendment of Dowry Prohibition Act, Penal Code and Nari-o-Shishu Nirjatan Daman Ain
- Conducting awareness building activities for establishing the legal rights of women

Name of assignment or project: Preparation of a Draft Updated DTCA Act, & Proposed Organogram, Rules and Regulations:

Year: 2019

Location: Dhaka

Client: Dhaka Transport Coordination Authority (DTCA), Bangladesh

Main project features: The objective of this assignment is to critically examine the existing DTCA Act and draft a new laws and regulations for establishment of National Urban Transport Agency to strengthen its future role.

Position: Legal Expert

Activities performed:

- Review and revisit DTCA Act, 2012 including existing rules and regulations with a view to preparing rules, regulations & procedures and related operational guidelines
- Review similar documents of the government
- Analyze present organogram to perform the functions & power mentioned in section 9 of DTCA Act, 2012 and proposes an organogram accordingly.
- Prepare a Draft rules to fulfill the objectives of the assignment
- Prepare Traffic Circulation & Traffic Safety for pedestrians regulations
- Prepare approval procedure for construction of transport related infrastructure
- Analyze present organogram to perform the functions & power mentioned in section 9 of DTCA Act 2012 and proposes an organogram accordingly.
- Translate the documents in English.

Name of assignment or project: Gender Dimension of Trade Facilitation of Agreement (GDTFa)

Year: 2018-2020

Location: Dhaka

Client: The Department for International Development (DFID) and CUTS International

Main project features: The key purpose of this Project was to enable best practice for women in facilitating trades across borders.

Position: Project Advisor

Activities performed:

- Extensive research on identifying the key challenges faced by women engaged in trade operations across borders.
- Interviewing the women engaged in trade operations across borders, custom officials and other relevant public officials in this regard.
- Recommendation for overcoming those challenges by taking appropriate administrative and legal steps.
- Participating in Sharing Experience event held in Nepal and adopting best practices managed by the SAARC countries in the context of our socio-economic perspective.

ADDITIONAL ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES

2018-2019

Project Advisor

Gender Dimensions of Trade Facilitation Agreement (GDTFa), DFID

Working as Project Advisor of the GDTFa project and visited countries like India, Bhutan, Nepal to enable best practices in Bangladesh for facilitating trades by implementing policies of neighbour countries.

2010-2018	Focal Point United Nations Office on Drugs & Crime (UNODC) Worked with UNODC, Vienna in relation to the United Nations Convention Against Corruption (UNCAC) Review Mechanism (1st & 2nd Year Cycle).
2013-2016	Project Director Policy Advocacy & Legislative Reform for Children Legislative & Parliamentary Affairs Division under Ministry of Law, Justice & Parliamentary Affairs with Technical support from UNICEF
2014	Director Dhaka Stock Exchange Implementing the Act of Demutualization and active role in policy making and preparation of guidelines.
2009-2015	Syndicate Member Bangladesh University of Professionals
1997-2007	Director National Legal Aid Services Organization Preparation of legal aid rules, regulation and guidelines under the Legal Aid Act
RESOURCE PERSON	• The Institute of Chartered Accountants of Bangladesh (ICAB) • The Institute of Cost and Management Accountants of Bangladesh (ICMAB) • The Institute of Chartered Secretaries of Bangladesh (ICSB) • Intellectual Property Association of Bangladesh (IPAB) • Bangladesh International Arbitration Centre (BIAC)
REFERENCE	Zinat Ara Chairman, Bangladesh Law Commission. Former Justice (Appellate Division), Supreme Court of Bangladesh. Contact: 01711564624

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